

Makhaarij — Articulation Points

■ This is a study companion for your Tajweed course. Each bullet point is a key concept from the video lecture. Review these pointers before or after each lesson.

What Are Makhaarij?

- Makhaarij (plural of Makhrij) = the origin points of each Arabic letter
- Every letter must be produced from its correct position in the mouth or throat
- There are 17 specific articulation points grouped into 5 main areas
- Saying a letter from the wrong place = a different letter entirely

The 5 Main Areas

- 1. Al-Jawf (■■■■■■■■) — The Empty Space — for long vowels: Alif, Waw, Ya
- 2. Al-Halq (■■■■■■■■) — The Throat — 6 letters at 3 levels
- 3. Al-Lisaan (■■■■■■■■■■) — The Tongue — 18 letters at various tongue positions
- 4. Ash-Shafataan (■■■■■■■■■■■■) — The Two Lips — 4 letters
- 5. Al-Khayshoom (■■■■■■■■■■■■) — Nasal Cavity — Ghunnah (nasal resonance)

Throat Letters — Al-Halq (6 Letters)

- DEEP throat (lowest): Hamza (■) and Ha (■)
- MIDDLE throat: Ayn (■) and Haa (■)
- TOP of throat / closest to mouth: Ghayn (■) and Kha (■)
- Practice tip: Put finger on throat — feel different levels as you say each

Lip Letters — Ash-Shafataan (4 Letters)

- Ba (■) — both lips meet completely with a pop
- Meem (■) — both lips meet + nasal sound resonates
- Waw (■) — lips rounded and pushed forward (do NOT touch)
- Fa (■) — lower lip lightly touches upper front teeth

Tongue Letters — Key Ones

- Qaaf (■) — very back of tongue against the soft palate (deep)
- Kaaf (■) — back of tongue, slightly more forward than Qaaf
- Jeem (■) / Sheen (■) / Ya (■) — middle of tongue against upper palate
- Noon (■) / Laam (■) / Ra (■) — tip of tongue, various positions
- Taa (■) / Daal (■) / Zaa (■) — tongue tip against upper teeth

Critical Distinctions

- Haa (هـ) vs Ha (ح): both are 'h' sounds in English, but different makhraj in Arabic
- Saad (س) vs Seen (س): same area but Saad is heavy/emphatic
- Qaaf (ق) vs Kaaf (ك): both 'k' sounds but different throat depths
- Taa (ط) vs Taa (ظ): same area but Taa is heavy/emphatic
- NEVER interchange these — it changes the Quranic meaning

Practice Method

- Say Alif (ا) — feel it at the very base of your throat
- Say Haa (هـ) — feel air rush from the middle of your throat
- Say Kha (خ) — feel the rasping near the back of your mouth
- Say Qaaf (ق) — press the very back of your tongue upward
- Practice each letter 10 times focusing on the physical position